

An empirical example: *Rhinoclemmys* data

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To evaluate the effect of branch length on the area(s) chosen for conservation, I conduct a Phylogenetic Diversity (PD) analysis for the *Rhinoclemmys* genus. The topology I will use corresponds to a Total Evidence analysis from Romero-Alarcon (2020), and the distribution will be modified from Le and McCord (2008).

Read the data: the distribution, and the tree

```
## For reproductibility purposes

set.seed(121)

options(warn=-1)
library(ggplot2)
suppressMessages(library(ggtree))
#~ library(ape)
suppressMessages(library(blepd))

suppressMessages(library(phytools))

#~ library(ggtree)
##
## Just in case, if you want to install ggtree.
##
### https://bioconductor.org/packages/release/bioc/html/ggtree.html
##
####
# if (!require("BiocManager", quietly = TRUE))
#   install.packages("BiocManager")
# BiocManager::install("ggtree")

## Version

cat("Analyses made with blepd version:", unlist(packageVersion("blepd"))))

## Analyses made with blepd version: 0 3 0 2024 7 21
## Create an object to place the distribution and the tree

RhinoclemmysData <- list()

## Read data
```

```

## distribution is a labeled csv file, areas by terminals

#setwd("./csv/")

## getwd()

csvFile <- list.files(pattern="csv")

## csvFile

### the functions use a matrix object for the distributions

RhinoclemmysData$distribution <- as.matrix(read.table(csvFile,
  stringsAsFactors=FALSE,
  header=TRUE,
  row.names=1,
  sep=",")
)

print(t(RhinoclemmysData$distribution))

##
## R_annulata      Al An-As Cho Nsa Nuh Ph Pl
## R_areolata      1    0  1  0  0  1  0
## R_diademata      1    0  0  0  0  0  0
## R_funerea        0    0  0  1  0  0  0
## R_melanosterna   1    0  0  0  1  0  0
## R_nasuta         0    0  1  0  0  0  0
## R_pulcherrima    0    0  0  0  1  0  1
## R_punctularia    0    1  0  0  0  0  0
## R_rubida         0    0  0  0  0  0  1

## tree(s) in nexus or newick format

##setwd("../tree/")

treeFiles <- list.files(pattern=".tre")

##treeFiles

RhinoclemmysData$tree <- read.tree(treeFiles)

## name of tree(s)

treeFiles <- gsub(".tre","",treeFiles)

## Plotting

#par(mfrow=c(2,1))

```

```
## The tree

## using ggtree

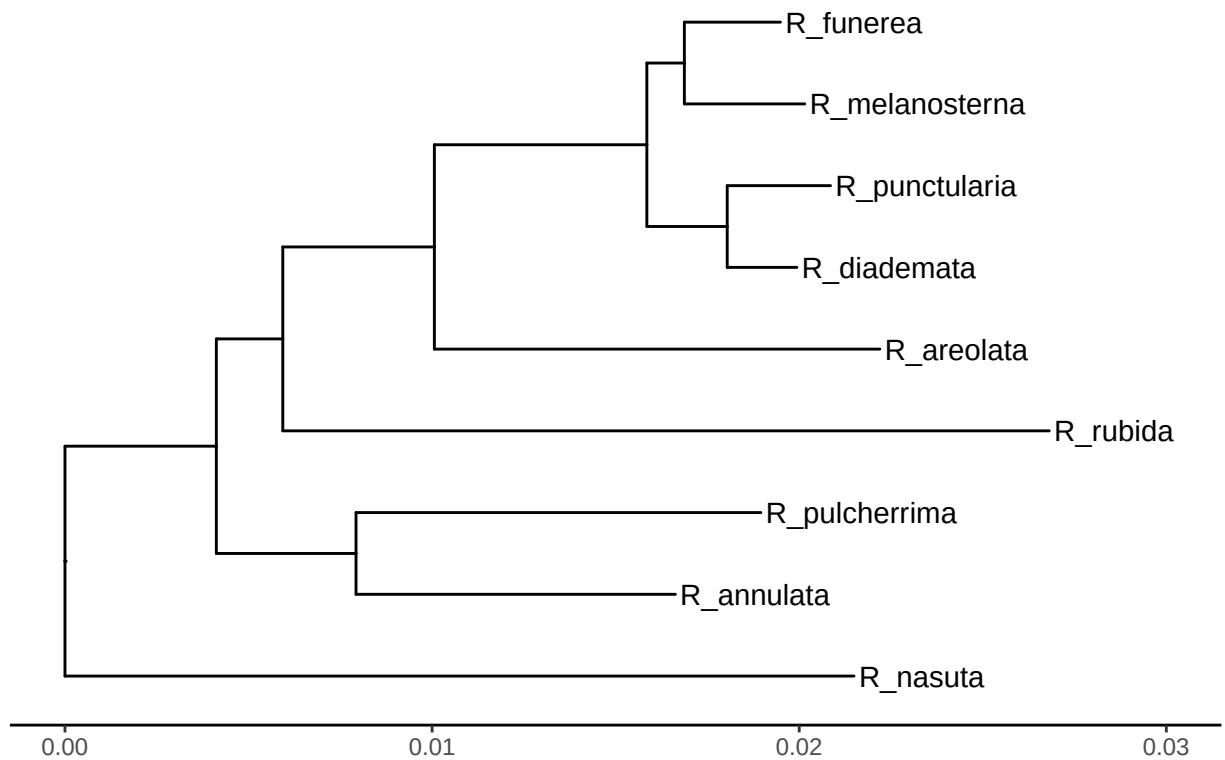
# RhinoclemmysData$tree <- reorder(RhinoclemmysData$tree, order = "cladewise")

plotTree <- ggtree(RhinoclemmysData$tree, ladderize=TRUE,
                   color="black", size=0.51, linetype="solid") +
  geom_tiplab(size=4, color="black") +
  xlim(0,0.030) +
  theme_tree2() +
  ggtitle(treeFiles[1])

##

print(plotTree)
```

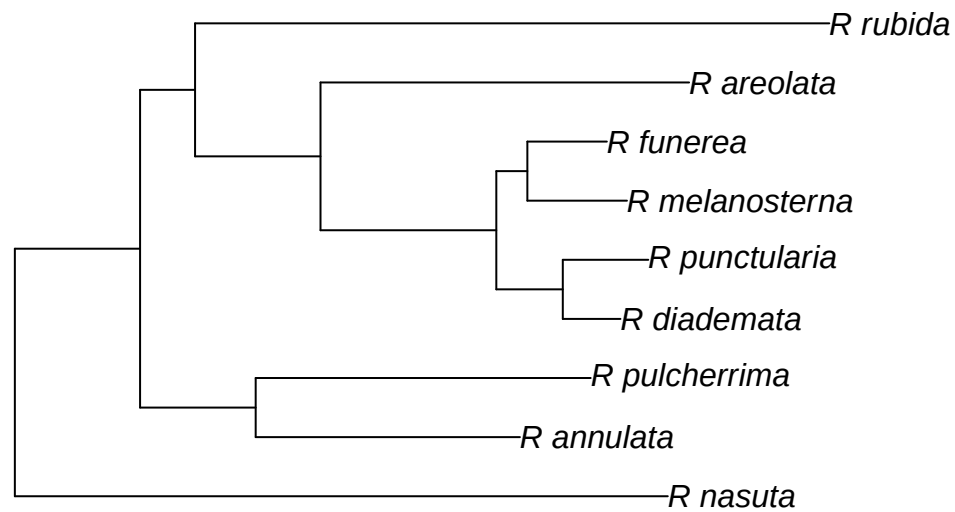
Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML



```
##~ Alternatively, we can plot the trees using APE

##
##

plot.phylo(RhinoclemmysData$tree)
```



```

##

####nodelabels()
####tiplabels()

## to plot the distribution, we must transform it into a data.frame
## object

## distXY <- matrix2XY(RhinoclemmysData$distribution)

## We could reorder the data.frame following the names on the trees

## terminals <- colnames(RhinoclemmysData$distribution)

## realOrder <- match(terminals,RhinoclemmysData$tree$tip.label)

## equivalencias <- data.frame(terminals,realOrder)

## dXY2 <- distXY

## for(cambiar in terminals){
##   dXY2$Terminal[distXY$Terminal == cambiar] <-
##   equivalencias$realOrder[equivalencias$terminals==cambiar]
##}

```

```

## distGraficar <- distXY

#~ distGraficar <- dXY2

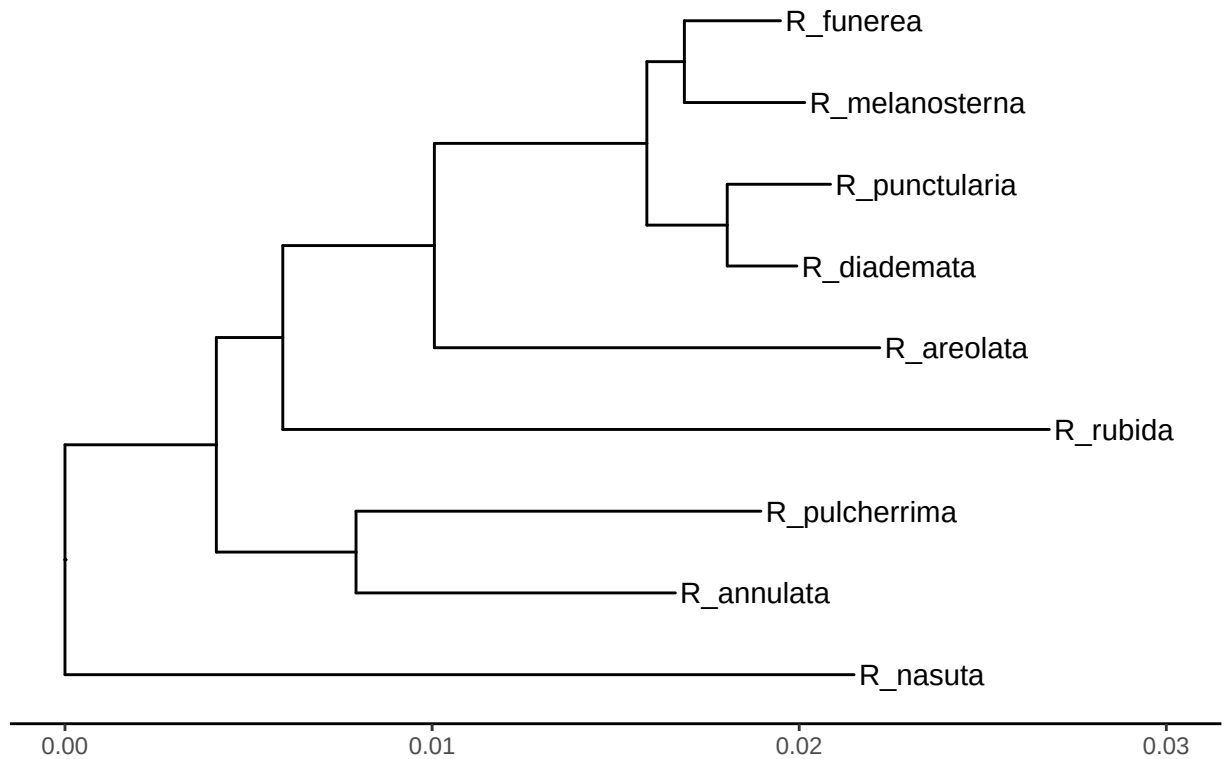
## plot using ggplot

# plotDistrib <- ggplot(distGraficar,
#                         aes(x= Area, y=Terminal), size =30) +
#                         geom_point(shape=19, fill="white",
#                                     color="darkgrey",
#                                     size=4) +
#                         labs(title = "Distribution",
#                              y = "",
#                              x = "Area") +
#                         theme(axis.line=element_blank(),
#                              # axis.text.y=element_blank(),
#                              axis.ticks=element_blank(),
#                              # axis.title.y=element_blank(),
#                              legend.position="none",
#                              panel.background=element_blank(),
#                              panel.border=element_blank(),
#                              panel.grid.major=element_blank(),
#                              panel.grid.minor=element_blank(),
#                              plot.background=element_blank()
#                              )
#
## cowplot::plot_grid(plotTree,plotDistrib, ncol=1)

plot(plotTree)

```

Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML



```
#~ plot(plotDistrib)
```

```
print(t(RhinoclemmysData$distribution))
```

```
##           Al An-As  Cho  Nsa  Nuh  Ph  Pl
## R_annulata    1     0   1   0   0   1   0
## R_areolata    1     0   0   0   0   0   0
## R_diademata    0     0   0   1   0   0   0
## R_funerea     1     0   0   0   1   0   0
## R_melanosterna 0     0   1   0   0   1   0
## R_nasuta      0     0   1   0   0   0   0
## R_pulcherrima  0     0   0   0   1   0   1
## R_punctularia  0     1   0   0   0   0   0
## R_rubida      0     0   0   0   0   0   1
```

```
##dev.off()
```

Now we plot the branch lengths

```
library(ggplot2)
```

```
##par(mfrow=c(2,1))
```

```
datos <- RhinoclemmysData$tree$edge.length
data <- as.data.frame(datos)
```

```

a <- ggplot2::ggplot(data, aes(x=datos)) +
  geom_histogram(bins = 12) +
  labs(title = treeFiles, x = "Branch length: internals and terminals", y = "Frequency") +
  xlim(c(0.001, 0.025)) +
  ylim(c(0, 5))

terminals <- RhinoclemmysData$tree$edge[,2] < 1 + length(RhinoclemmysData$tree$tip.label)

datos <- RhinoclemmysData$tree$edge.length[terminals]
data <- as.data.frame(datos)

b <- ggplot(data, aes(x=datos)) +
  geom_histogram(bins = 12) +
  labs(x = "Branch length: terminals", y = "Frequency") +
  xlim(c(0.001, 0.025)) +
  ylim(c(0, 5))

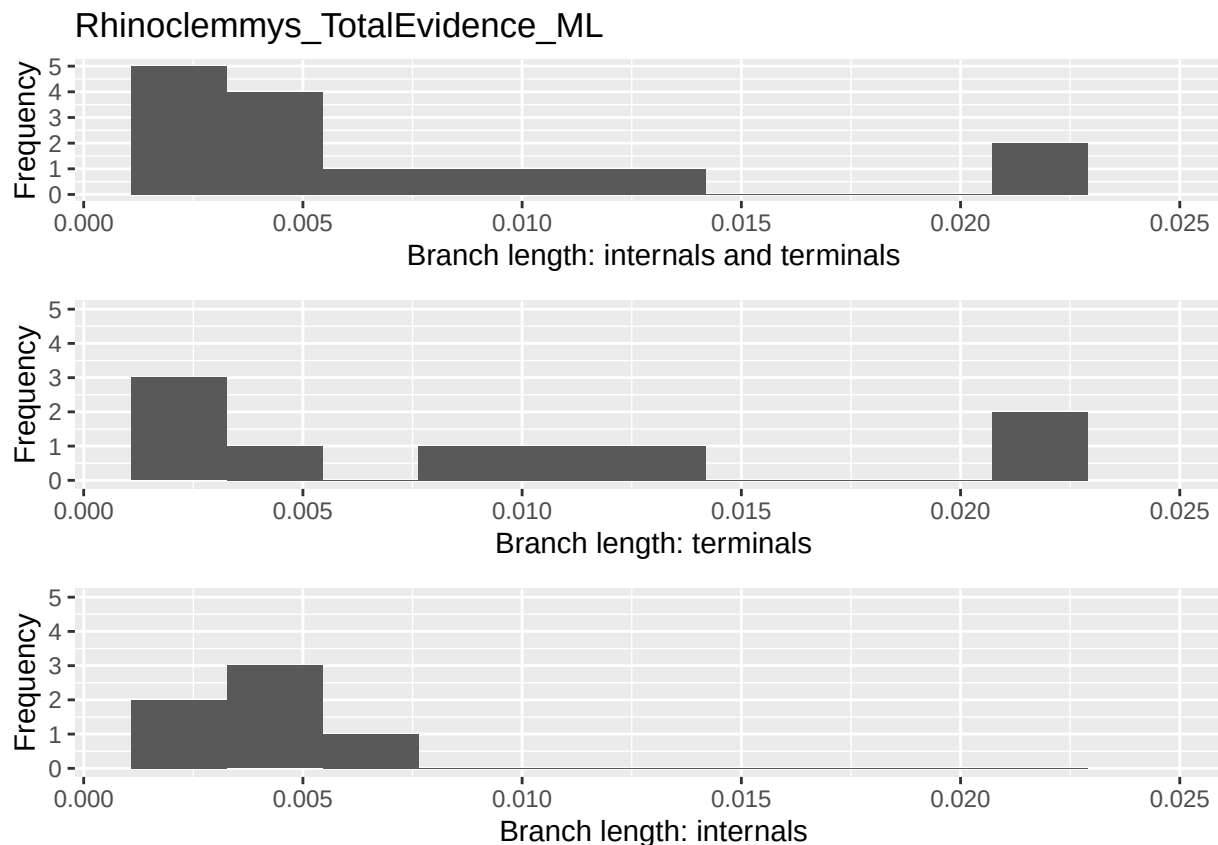
datos <- RhinoclemmysData$tree$edge.length[!terminals]
data <- as.data.frame(datos)

c <- ggplot(data, aes(x=datos)) +
  geom_histogram(bins = 12) +
  labs(x = "Branch length: internals", y = "Frequency") +
  xlim(c(0.001, 0.025)) +
  ylim(c(0, 5))

##

cowplot::plot_grid(a, b, c, nrow=3)

```



```
##
#
# cat("Terminals, with BL larger than 0.02 = ",
# findTerminalgivenLength(RhinoclemmysData$tree,0.02))
#
##

###dev.off()
```

The branch length histograms and the tree plot show that the internal length branches are similar among each other, and different to terminals'; there are two longer branches (larger than 0.02), *R. nasuta* (inhabiting Cho) and *R. rubida* (PI), whereas AI and Cho are the richest.

PD values

First, I calculate the PD value for the areas, given this tree.

```
RhinoclemmysData$tablePD <- PDindex(RhinoclemmysData$tree,
                                     distribution=RhinoclemmysData$distribution,
                                     root=TRUE,
                                     percentual = TRUE)

RhinoclemmysData$matrixPD <- as.data.frame(
  matrix(
    unlist(RhinoclemmysData$tablePD),
```



```

                                nrow= length(treeFiles),
                                byrow=TRUE))

colnames(RhinoclemmysData$matrixPD) <- row.names(RhinoclemmysData$distribution)

row.names(RhinoclemmysData$matrixPD) <- "PD value"

new <- (t(RhinoclemmysData$matrixPD))

## officially I am an Idiot

values <- new[order(new[,1])]
names <- rownames(new)[order(new[,1])]

print(as.data.frame(paste(names,values)))

## paste(names, values)
## 1          Nsa 8.05
## 2        An-As 8.42
## 3          Ph 13.18
## 4          Nuh 13.86
## 5          Pl 16.81
## 6          Al 17.82
## 7          Cho 21.86

## cat("Max value is:",max(t(RhinoclemmysData$matrixPD)),"Area:",
## colnames(RhinoclemmysData$matrixPD)[which.max(t(RhinoclemmysData$matrixPD))])

```

The highest PD is for area Cho, followed by Al, the two richest areas, and the difference in PD value is not given by the richness but the species in each region.

#Effect of branch lengths in the PD

We test the effect of the branch length on the PD values by swapping terminal and/or internal branch lengths using the three available models.

```

for( modelo in c("simpleswap","allswap","uniform") ){

  for( rama in c("terminals","internals","all") ){

    val <- swapBL(RhinoclemmysData$tree,
                  RhinoclemmysData$distribution,
                  model = modelo,
                  branch = rama
                )

    cat( "\n\t Tree=",treeFiles,"\n\t Model=",modelo,
          "\n\t Branchs swapped=",rama,"\n" )

    printBlepd(val)

    cat( "\n\n\n" )

  }
}

```

```

}

## model to test simpleswap reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= simpleswap
##   Branchs swapped= terminals
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           A1    13      13
## 2           Cho    85      85
## 3           Pl     2       2
##
##
##
## model to test simpleswap reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= simpleswap
##   Branchs swapped= internals
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           Cho  100      100
##
##
##
## model to test simpleswap reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= simpleswap
##   Branchs swapped= all
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           A1     8       8
## 2           Cho    91      91
## 3           Pl     1       1
##
##
##
## model to test allswap reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= allswap
##   Branchs swapped= terminals
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           A1    35      35
## 2           Cho    53      53
## 3           Nuh    10      10
## 4           Pl     2       2

```

```

##
##
##
## model to test allswap reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= allswap
##   Branchs swapped= internals
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           Cho  100    100
##
##
##
## model to test allswap reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= allswap
##   Branchs swapped= all
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           Al   37     37
## 2          An-As   4      4
## 3           Cho  33     33
## 4           Nsa   4      4
## 5           Nuh  19     19
## 6           Pl   3      3
##
##
##
## model to test uniform reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= uniform
##   Branchs swapped= terminals
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           Al   46     46
## 2           Cho  50     50
## 3           Nuh   4      4
##
##
##
## model to test uniform reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= uniform
##   Branchs swapped= internals
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent

```

```
## 1          Cho  100    100
##
##
##
## model to test uniform reps 100
##
##   Tree= Rhinoclemmys_TotalEvidence_ML
##   Model= uniform
##   Branchs swapped= all
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           Al   38      38
## 2          An-As    1       1
## 3           Cho   53      53
## 4           Nsa    1       1
## 5           Nuh    7       7
```

The terminal branch length is critical in the decision taken, if we swap all terminal branch lengths (model= “allswap”), or if we replace them with a uniform distribution (model= “uniform”), the area selected change from Cho to Al.

As the terminal branch lengths are distributed unequally, we might suspect that the results could depend on the longest branches that inhabit Cho/Al areas.

First, we tested whether the number of replicates had any effect.

```
for(repetir in 1:2){

    val <- swapBL( RhinoclemmysData$tree,
                   RhinoclemmysData$distribution,
                   model = "allswap",
                   branch = "terminals",
                   nTimes = 10**repetir
                 )

    printBlepd(val)

}
```

```
## model to test allswap reps 10
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           Al    1       10
## 2           Cho    6       60
## 3           Nuh    3       30
## model to test allswap reps 100
##
## BestInitial:Cho
##   AreaSelected Freq Percent
## 1           Al   39      39
## 2           Cho   40      40
## 3           Nsa    1       1
## 4           Nuh   19      19
## 5           Pl    1       1
```

Roughly speaking, from 1000 on the results are alike, and the largest The difference was the use of 10 or 100 replicates. As a rule of thumb, we must use at least 100 replicates, but 1000 replicates would be better.

Now, let us see if the difference in results could be assigned to the longest branches (or not).

```
## we can use a single command (*evalBranch*)

AllTerminals <- evalBranch(tree=RhinoclemmysData$tree,
                           distribution=RhinoclemmysData$distribution,
                           branchToEval="terminals",
                           approach="all",
                           printNames=TRUE)

printEvalBranch(AllTerminals)
```

```
##           node initialArea FinalArea Aproach  %Delta
## 1      [R_nasuta]|1          Cho      A1   lower  -47.18
## 12 [R_pulcherrima]|3          Cho      P1   upper  116.08
## 13  [R_diademata]|4          Cho      Nsa   upper 1819.58
## 14 [R_punctularia]|5          Cho     An-As   upper 1202.58
## 16   [R_funerea]|7          Cho      A1   upper  391.02
## 17  [R_areolata]|8          Cho      A1   upper   84.95
## 18   [R_rubida]|9          Cho      P1   upper   61.32
```

```
AllInternals <- evalBranch(tree=RhinoclemmysData$tree,
                           distribution=RhinoclemmysData$distribution,
                           branchToEval="internals",
                           approach="all",
                           printNames=TRUE)

printEvalBranch(AllInternals)
```

```
##           node initialArea FinalArea Aproach
## 13 [node number:16:R_diademata/R_punctularia]|16          Cho     An-As   upper
##      %Delta
## 13 1529.13
```

The selected area depended on the branch length. While the internal terminals had almost no impact, if the terminal branch length of *R. nasuta* is -47.18% shorter, or if the terminal branch length is 84.95% larger for *R. areolata*, the area selected will change from Cho to A1, and if the terminal branch length of *R. rubida* is 61.32% larger, and the area selected changes from Cho to P1.

If the tree is ultrametric, the pair of sister pairs will behave alike, and the difference will be given by the distribution.

```
## now let's see the impact of ultra-metricity

AllTerminalsU <- evalBranch(tree=force.ultrametric(RhinoclemmysData$tree),
                           distribution=RhinoclemmysData$distribution,
                           branchToEval="terminals",
                           approach="all",
                           printNames=TRUE)
```

```
## *****
## *                               Note:                               *
## *   force.ultrametric does not include a formal method to         *
## *   ultrametricize a tree & should only be used to coerce         *
## *   a phylogeny that fails is.ultrametric due to rounding --      *
```

```
## *    not as a substitute for formal rate-smoothing methods.    *
## *****
```

```
cat("Ultrametric tree\n")
```

```
## Ultrametric tree
```

```
printEvalBranch(AllTerminalsU)
```

```
##
##          node initialArea FinalArea Approach %Delta
## 9      [R_nasuta]|1          Cho          A1    lower  -47.97
## 11     [R_funerea]|7          Cho          A1    upper  349.96
## 12     [R_diademata]|4        Cho          Nsa    upper 1567.21
## 13 [R_punctularia]|5          Cho        An-As    upper 1567.21
## 14     [R_areolata]|8          Cho          A1    upper   91.64
## 15      [R_rubida]|9          Cho          P1    upper  132.31
## 17 [R_pulcherrima]|3          Cho        NuhP1    upper   215.5
```

```
printEvalBranch(AllTerminals)
```

```
##
##          node initialArea FinalArea Approach %Delta
## 1      [R_nasuta]|1          Cho          A1    lower  -47.18
## 12 [R_pulcherrima]|3          Cho          P1    upper  116.08
## 13     [R_diademata]|4        Cho          Nsa    upper 1819.58
## 14 [R_punctularia]|5          Cho        An-As    upper 1202.58
## 16     [R_funerea]|7          Cho          A1    upper   391.02
## 17     [R_areolata]|8          Cho          A1    upper    84.95
## 18      [R_rubida]|9          Cho          P1    upper    61.32
```

```
AllInternalsU <- evalBranch(tree=force.ultrametric(RhinoclemmysData$tree),
                           distribution=RhinoclemmysData$distribution,
                           branchToEval="internals",
                           approach="all",
                           printNames=TRUE)
```

```
## *****
## *
## *          Note:
## *
## *    force.ultrametric does not include a formal method to
## *    ultrametricize a tree & should only be used to coerce
## *    a phylogeny that fails is.ultrametric due to rounding --
## *    not as a substitute for formal rate-smoothing methods.
## *
## *****
```

```
printEvalBranch(AllInternalsU)
```

```
##
##          node initialArea FinalArea Approach
## 8 [node number:16:R_diademata/R_punctularia]|16          Cho An-AsNsa    upper
## %Delta
## 8 1981.8
```

```
printEvalBranch(AllInternals)
```

```
##
##          node initialArea FinalArea Approach
## 13 [node number:16:R_diademata/R_punctularia]|16          Cho    An-As    upper
## %Delta
## 13 1529.13
```

Literature cited

- Le, Minh, and William P. McCord. 2008. “Phylogenetic relationships and biogeographical history of the genus *Rhinoclemmys* Fitzinger, 1835 and the monophyly of the turtle family Geoemydidae (Testudines: Testudinoidea).” *Zoological Journal of the Linnean Society* 153 (4): 751–67. <https://doi.org/10.1111/j.1096-3642.2008.00413.x>.
- Romero-Alarcon, L. Viviana. 2020. “A total-evidence phylogeny of the crown and stem-groups of turtles (Pantestudines: Testudinata).” Master’s thesis, Colombia: Escuela de Biología, UIS.